Embedded Sponsorship API

Overview

The Embedded Sponsorship API allows partners to integrate ZipRecruiter's job sponsorship capabilities directly into their ATS. Partners can generate access tokens for their users, check sponsorship status of jobs, and embed sponsorship flows in their UI.

6 Steps to Get Started

Get a sponsorship button working in your ATS in six easy steps:

1. **Get credentials** — Receive a Job API Key and a Sponsorship API Key (a single `Authorization: Basic` credential) from your ZipRecruiter partner contact. Also provide all domains where you will embed the SDK (including dev, staging, and production) so ZipRecruiter can whitelist them. The iframe will not load until your domains are whitelisted.
2. **Post a job** — Use the Jobs API to create a job listing. A job must exist before it can be sponsored.
3. **Map user roles** — Decide which roles to assign each ATS user type (e.g., admin gets `can-sponsor`, `can-view-all-jobs`, `can-unsponsor`, `can-manage-billing`; recruiter gets `can-sponsor`, `can-view-all-jobs`, `can-unsponsor`).
4. **Exchange credentials for an access token** — Your server calls `POST /ats-embed/v0/api/token` with Basic Auth to get a short-lived access token.
5. **Include the SDK and annotate job elements** — Add the Sponsorship SDK script tag to your ATS page with the access token, and add `data-zr-job-id` attributes to each job element.
6. **See the button** — The SDK automatically renders a "Sponsor on ZipRecruiter" button inside each annotated element. On completion, it updates to "Pause ZipRecruiter

Sponsorship."

For detailed SDK setup instructions, see the Sponsorship SDK guide.

Authentication

The Sponsorship API uses Basic authentication to allow access to all endpoints. You will be provided an API key separate from your Jobs API key; please keep it secret.

> **NOTE**
>
> If your client's Basic Auth library requires separate `username` and `password` fields, simply decode the key we provide.

▼ Example authentication header

```
curl https://api.ziprecruiter.com/ats-embed/v0/api/token \
  -H "Authorization: Basic YOUR_SPONSORSHIP_API_KEY" ...
```

Operations

Token Exchange

`POST /ats-embed/v0/api/token`

Exchange Sponsorship API credentials for an access token.

Example request

```
curl -X POST https://api.ziprecruiter.com/ats-embed/v0/api/token \
  -H "Authorization: Basic YOUR_SPONSORSHIP_API_KEY" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{
    "email": "hiring@acme.com",
    "externalEmployerId": "emp-456",
    "atsUserId": "user-789",
    "roles": ["can-sponsor", "can-view-all-jobs", "can-manage-
billing"]
  }'
```

Example response

Response

```
{
  "access_token": "eyJhbGciOiJkaXIiLCJlbmMiOi...",
  "expires_in": 7200,
  "user": {
    "email": "hiring@acme.com",
    "state": "returning"
  }
}
```

Request Headers

Header	Description

Header	Description
`Authorization`	`Basic YOUR_SPONSORSHIP_API_KEY`
`Content-Type`	`application/json`

Request Body

▼ Request body fields

Field	Required	Type	Description
`email`	Yes	string	User's email address.
`externalEmployerId`	Yes	string	Unique employer identifier in your system.
`facilityId`	No	string	Optional finer-grained identifier under `externalEmployerId` — see Facilities below.
`atsUserId`	Yes	string	User's unique identifier in your ATS.
`roles`	No	string[]	Permissions for this user (see Roles). If omitted or empty, the user has no permissions.
`companyName`	No	string	Employer company name (pre-fills registration).
`website`	No	string	Company website URL (pre-fills

Field	Required	Type	Description
			registration).
`zip`	No	string	Company zip code (pre-fills registration).
`fullName`	No	string	User's full name (pre-fills registration).
`title`	No	string	User's job title (pre-fills registration).
`phone`	No	string	User's phone number (pre-fills registration).

Response Body

▼ Response body fields

Field	Required	Type	Description
`access_token`	Yes	string	Bearer token (JWT) for subsequent API calls.
`expires_in`	Yes	integer	Token lifetime in seconds (7200 = 2 hours).
`user`	Yes	object	User identity and account state.
`user.email`	Yes	string	The email address from the request.

Field	Required	Type	Description
`user.state`	Yes	string	Account state: `"returning"`, `"new"`, `"verify-identity"`, or `"no-access"`.

Facilities

If your `externalEmployerId` represents a parent account that covers multiple locations or sub-brands (for example, a franchise with several facilities), pass an optional `facilityId` on the token exchange request to keep each facility's billing separate.

- Users who share the same `externalEmployerId` **and** the same `facilityId` (including users who never send a `facilityId`) end up in the same ZipRecruiter organization, with one shared payment method and plan.
- The first `facilityId` seen for a given `externalEmployerId` establishes a new, independent ZipRecruiter organization for that facility. Every subsequent request with the same `externalEmployerId` + `facilityId` pair routes new users into that same organization.
- Omitting `facilityId` is equivalent to using one fixed default facility for that employer — existing integrations that never send it see no change.
- This affects new users only: an ATS user who already has a ZipRecruiter account continues to use their own existing organization, regardless of `facilityId`.

Sponsored Status

`POST /ats-embed/v0/api/sponsored_status`

Determine which jobs are currently sponsored.

Example request

```
curl -X POST "https://api.ziprecruiter.com/ats-embed/v0/api/
sponsored_status" \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{ "jobIds": ["job-010", "job-011"] }'
```

Example response

Response

```
{
  "success": true,
  "statuses": {
    "job-010": "sponsored",
    "job-011": "unsponsored"
  }
}
```

Request Headers

Header	Description
`Authorization`	`Bearer ACCESS_TOKEN`
`Content-Type`	`application/json`

Request Body

Field	Required	Type	Description
`jobIds`	Yes	string[]	Array of external job IDs (max 50).

Embed Flow URLs

The sponsorship widget is loaded in an iframe using the URLs below. Pass the external job ID and the access token obtained from the token exchange.

▸ Embed flow URLs and parameters

Roles

Roles control what a user can do inside the sponsorship widget. Assign roles per user when generating their access token (see the `roles` parameter in Token Exchange).

▸ Available roles

> **NOTE**
>
> If `roles` is omitted or empty, the user has **no permissions** and cannot perform any gated actions. Roles are enforced server-side. The widget displays appropriate messages for each permission state, but the API independently rejects unauthorized requests.

Typical Role Assignments

▸ Typical role assignments by user type

Error Responses

All Sponsorship API responses include a `success` boolean at the top level. On failure, `success` is `false` and an `error` object is included:

▸ Example error response

▸ Error codes

Rate Limits

All Sponsorship API endpoints are rate-limited. When a limit is exceeded the API returns HTTP `429` with a `Retry-After` header.

▾ Rate limit response headers

Response Headers

The following headers are included on every Sponsorship API response:

Header	Description
`X-RateLimit-Limit`	Maximum requests allowed in the current window.
`X-RateLimit-Remaining`	Requests remaining in the current window.
`Retry-After`	Seconds until the window resets (only on `429` responses).

▼ Token endpoint limits

Token Endpoint Limits

`POST /ats-embed/v0/api/token` is subject to two independent limits, both keyed on `client_id`. A request is rejected if **either** limit is exceeded.

Scope	Limit	Window	Notes
Per `client_id`	3,000 requests	1 minute	Burst protection. Cache tokens and refresh before expiry.
Per `client_id`	100,000 requests	1 hour	Overall budget across all employers for a single partner.

▼ Sponsored status endpoint limits

Sponsored Status Endpoint Limits

`POST /ats-embed/v0/api/sponsored_status` is rate-limited per user.

Limit	Window
60 requests	1 minute